

Vittoria Iannotta

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes.

EDUCATION

PhD candidate in Economics at HEC Paris	2023 - present
Advisor: Prof. Gaetano Gaballo	
• Summer 2025, Summer Graduate Program in honor of Ivan Jaccard, Research Department of the European Central Bank References: Simone Manganelli , David Marqués-Ibáñez • Fall 2024/25, Visiting Scholar, University of Pennsylvania - Economics. Sponsor: Prof. Guillermo Ordóñez	
M.S. in Management Sciences - HEC Paris	2021 - 2023
M.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - Bocconi University Thesis Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Giavazzi	2017 - 2020
B.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - Bocconi University	2014 - 2017

REFERENCES

Prof. Gaetano Gaballo

Advisor

Professor of Economics, HEC Paris
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Prof. Johan Hombert

Dissertation Committee

Professor of Finance, HEC Paris
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Letter Writer

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Letter Writer

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JOB MARKET PAPER

Default risk surprises and banks' loan pricing.

Using one million loan-, bank-, firm-level observations in France, combined with public rating scores, I document that interest rate differentials unexplained by observables at loan issuance contain forward information about future changes in firms' default probability. On average, firms whose default probability deteriorates by 1 p.p. one year after loan issuance were charged an otherwise unexplained 0.04 p.p. rate

premium at loan issuance. The forward information content of loan rates declines at longer horizons, it doubles for safer, younger and smaller firms, and strengthens during crises. I exclude that higher rates can themselves increase firms' default probability by comparing fixed- versus variable-rate loans. Overall, information that banks know at loan issuance arises as a potential driver of interest rate dispersion and of the positive relationship between rates and risk. Yet, it is not necessary: search frictions à la Burdett and Judd can deliver the same pattern. I study these competing forces in a search model of loan pricing with asymmetric information and a public imperfect signal on firms' risk types. First, depending on the signal precision and the severity of adverse selection, banks choose to which extent to pool borrowers or to separate them through pricing. Second, riskier types are more likely to get higher rates either when the signal is sufficiently precise or when banks, although uninformed, offer partially separating contracts. Third, more information reallocates surplus from risky firms to safer firms and banks. Finally, I calibrate the model separately for each rating class, and I find that the equilibrium is close to the perfect-information benchmark in ex-ante safer markets, and to no-information in riskier ones.

PRESENTATIONS

The **Wharton School, Finance** (Internal presentation), Fall 2024. **Paris Macro Workshop**, May 2025. **European Central Bank** (Internal Seminar), May 2025. Economics Letters Summer School in Macro-Finance at **Bocconi SDA**, July 2025. **ICBFS Conference**, Piacenza, Sep 2025. 4th PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, Naples School of Economics (NSE) of the **University of Naples Federico II**, Sep 2025. 9th Dauphine Finance PhD Workshop, **Université Paris Dauphine - PSL**, June 2026. **European Summer Symposium in Financial Markets** (Evening Sessions), Jul 2026. **Fourth Women in Central Banking Workshop**, Banco de Mexico, forthcoming on Nov 6th.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Analyst, European Central Bank Apr 2020 - Jun 2021

Title: Traineeship (1 year) + Research Analyst (3 months). *Area:* Monetary Analysis.

Main Activities: Data collection (Orbis, ECB series), macroeconometric analysis of time series data (including monetary aggregates, bank lending volumes and interest rates), Microeconometric analysis of firm panel data (balance sheets, firm-bond links). *References:* [Fédéric Holm-Hadulla](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecturer, Introduction to Macroeconomics. 2022, 2023

Program: MSc in Economics and Finance, HEC Paris. *Latest teaching evaluations:* 4.32/5 (2023/24).

Teaching assistant for Prof. Michau, Advanced Macroeconomics. 2023, 2024, 2025

Program: MSc in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique. *Latest teaching evaluations:* 4.22/5 (2024/25)

Teaching assistant for Prof Ai-Ting Goh, Macroeconomics. 2024, 2025

Program: MBA simulation games, HEC Paris.

Instructor for ESSEC IRENE France, Game Theory for Negotiation 2026

Program: One-day Professional Training, delivered at the Council of the European Union.

SKILLS

Datasets experience:

Credit registries: French Credit Registries, P2P lenders registry (ACPR, Banque de France)

Firm-level data: National balance sheet data (FIBEN, Bank of France), Orbis, Amadeus (BvD)

Financial analysis: Eikon, Datastream

Macroeconomic analysis: ECB series, BSI, MIR

Statistical Packages and Programming:

R, Stata, Matlab (Advanced) data management, statistical and econometric analysis, visualisation

Python (Advanced) structural estimation, model simulations, visualization, webscraping.

SQL (Intermediate) data management

SPSS, Eviews (Basic) data management, statistical and econometric analysis

Microsoft Office PowerPoint, Word, Excel